

Devialet Mania

Pricy speaker that delivers on its promises

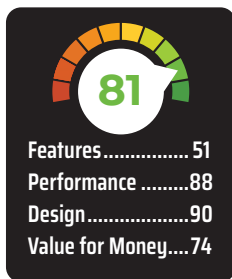
Devialet Mania is a speaker like no other. Let me describe the speaker to you. It is a speaker that sounds great, has a high price tag that matches its performance and design, and looks like it belongs to the audio setup of a UFO. I am pretty sure that if you put this prompt into an AI image generator, you will get something similar to that of the Devialet Mania. Now, when the speaker showed up at the Digit Test Centre, it was put through its paces against the best ones in the business, thanks to its nomination in the Digit Zero1 Awards 2023.

While it did lose out against the Marshall Middleton in the race to the top in our awards which are based on pure performance, when looking at the speaker as a whole, taking its build, design, and features into consideration, it fares pretty well. The premium Bluetooth speakers market, might look like a space where there is not a lot of competition, when you are out looking for one, the subtle differences in the speakers, make it a tough decision. So, if you are someone who was looking to buy the Devialet Mania, then you are in the right place. Here's my detailed review of the Devialet Mania, and how it fares against its competitors in the premium Bluetooth Speakers range –

BUILD AND DESIGN

As you might have seen with other Devialet speakers as well, the design of the Devialet Mania is also something that steers away from the conventional designs that we see in speakers. The Mania has an orb-like design that is solid overall. It has a plastic casing, which is covered by premium fabric. The

₹92,000



colours are monotonous for the most part, with the handle having different hues of the primary colour of the fabric covering the speaker's body.

There is a chrome finish on the lining of the driver, and the handle has a rubberised finish.

Overall, an attractive design that makes it stand out on its own, however, it does fit in aesthetics of most of the spaces that you will be placing it in. As for the materials, the build is mostly plastic, but it has a nice heft to it and the overall build is solid. The base of the speaker is rubberised and prevents the speaker from moving or rattling when the volume is cranked up to maximum. You will have no complaints whatsoever. You are most likely not to take such an expensive speaker out about, exposing it to the elements, but if you do, it is IPX4 certified. It will be protected against light splashes of water.

The buttons are integrated into the handle and are clicky and responsive. There is a dedicated switch to enable and disable the microphone, which is a plus, especially in these times of paranoia surrounding privacy concerns that come with speakers that have microphones built in. The suite of physical controls that is present on the speaker is also promising and does the job well. For added control, you can switch to your smartphone, where you can load the Devialet app. More on that in the next section.

FEATURES

In terms of its features, the Devialet Mania, like most other speakers that put sound above everything else, is not packed with features. There is the regular suite of features that improve the user experience, and here, the Devialet app shines bright, along with ASC - Active Stereo Calibration. The UI of the app matches the exquisite design language that has come to be synonymous with the brand. In the app, you get the perfect set of customisation features that will help you make the speaker truly your own, in terms of how it sounds.

What we noticed in our tests, the Devialet Mania does have a slight dip in the treble frequencies out of the box. You can change that in the app. It comes with a dual band EQ that lets you change the bass and treble frequencies. Apart from that you also have three different presets that you can choose from – Flat, Custom, and Voice. The app is available both on Android and iOS.

In terms of connectivity, you get both Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. In my tests, there were no noticeable latency issues. However, there have been reports of latency issues creeping in over Bluetooth. So, keep an eye out for that. You can also stream music using AirPlay, which will also let you chain compatible speakers. This feature is inherently missing on the speaker. I personally would love to have had it in the speaker. There is support for Spotify Connect as well, another much needed point in the bag. Once you have the speaker paired to your phone, you